

English Nexus

ESOL Offender Learning

Working to help others in prison

Topic: Support jobs around the prison

Level: Entry 1- Entry 3

Time: 90 minutes

Aims

- To develop learners' vocabulary for different support roles in a prison: job titles e.g. library orderly, learning mentor, Listener
- To develop learners' ability to read a job advert for gist and detail
- To be able to talk in simple terms about support roles in prison, how workers might benefit and what the jobs involve
- To be able to talk about personal qualities.

Introduction

This lesson is about support roles in prison. It provides learners with vocabulary to describe personal qualities and could support them with applying for future employment on release.

You will need:

- **Warmer images:** 1 per pair or group of 3 or 4. You could project this or photocopy it on A3 to show whole group.
- **Resource 1** (Entry 1-2): 1 copy per Entry 1 and 2 learner
- **Resource 1** (Entry 3): 1 copy per Entry 3 learner
- **Resource 2:** 1 copy cut per pair of learners
- **Resources 3 and 5:** 1 copy per learner
- **Resource 4:** 1 copy with texts cut into 3 per pair of learners
- Whiteboard (traditional or interactive) or flipchart

Suggested procedure

Warmer (5 minutes)

- Hand out **Warmer images** (or project them) and elicit some of the jobs the people do and why they wear different coloured T-shirts in prison.



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- Follow up with some more questions: 'Where do the people in the images work - on the wing, in the library, in healthcare?' 'Are they paid?' 'What are their jobs?' 'Which one is a Listener?' 'Which one is a PID worker?'
- Put their ideas on the board and make sure you cover all the jobs in task 1.

Task 1 – reading comprehension (15 minutes)

- Hand out **resource 1**. Give the learners one minute to look at the text and answer question 1. Make it fun and use a stopwatch on your interactive whiteboard if you have one.
- Feedback and ask a follow-up question to highlight different language and layout features in letters, adverts and news stories. Prompt them, if necessary: ask '*How do you start a letter?*'
- Now tell learners to read the rest of the questions. They read the text again and answer the questions with a partner.

Tip! Remind them to underline the key words in the questions and look for them in the text

- Feedback and ask what jobs the learners think sound interesting.

Differentiation

Make sure lower-level learners use the **simplified version** of this task.

Extension

Higher level learners could try to guess the meaning of formal words from the context.

Task 2 - Pre-teaching vocabulary (10 minutes)

- Write the adjectives 'kind', 'helpful' and 'hard-working' on the board. Explain that people often have to talk about themselves when they apply for a job.
- Elicit why it's useful to say something about yourself to employers. Ask the class about people they know and like: can they describe them? Add any more adjectives they suggest to the board.



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- Explain that they are going to learn more words to talk about themselves.
- Put the learners into pairs and give each pair a set of jumbled adjectives and definitions. The task is to match the definitions to the adjectives.
- Model this first. Read a definition and ask them to hold up a matching word.
- When they've finished, check together as a whole class. Drill the pronunciation of the adjectives.
- If they finish quickly, they could test each other by reading out the definitions and trying to remember the new words.

Task 3 – Questions: meet the applicants (5 minutes)

- Hand out **resource 3** (or display the photos on the board). Focus learners' attention on the photos and ask them what they think about them for example: *'How old are they? What jobs do they do? Who looks like a good library orderly?'*
- Focus learners' attention on the question prompts and elicit how to complete the questions.
- Check together afterwards. Use this as an opportunity to review question formation for example, if many learners miss out auxiliaries. You could do this by asking them to correct their own mistakes on the board.

Extension

Higher levels could write follow up questions, e.g. *'What work experience do you have? Do you have any qualifications?'*

Task 4 – Reading comprehension (10 minutes)

- Hand out one of texts on **resource 4** to each learner. Explain that learners should read the text, answer the questions in task 3 on **resource 3**.
- Learners should then write their answers in the appropriate column in the table. For smaller classes, use only one or two texts.

Differentiation



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- For lower level learners, make them sit in groups of three. They should answer the questions then compare their answers with the other two to check they are correct.
- Then give each learner number 1 to 3. All the number 1, 2 and 3s should sit together to do the second part of the task. This way each group will have someone who has read a different text.

Task 5 – Speaking and listening: information gap (15 minutes)

- Tell learners they are now going to speak to two different people to complete the rest of the table. Make sure they ask the questions from task 3, rather than just copying from their partner's reading text.
- Model this first and make a joke of not letting anyone see your text.
- When they have finished, check the answers, check that meaning is clear and ask for examples of personal qualities in perhaps people known to them- family, friends or maybe celebrities.

Extension

Learners look at the applicants' favourite quotes and comment on them. They might say what they think about them or why people like to have an inspirational quote.

Task 6: Vocabulary game (15 minutes)

- Divide the class into teams and tell them they are going to play a memory game. Make sure they put away their handouts.
- Read out a snippet from one of the texts: the first team to say the correct applicant's name wins a point.
- Continue until you've reviewed all the main points, focusing on personal qualities and strengths.
- Now put the three names on the board and get the teams to tell you their personal qualities and strengths. Put them on the board. Again, award a point for each correct answer.

Differentiation

- Less confident learners could look back at their texts and highlight the personal qualities and strengths that the rest of the team suggest.



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- In pairs learners play 'snap' (matching game) with the vocabulary from Resource 2: learners should turn over a word or definition then try to find the corresponding word or definition to match to it.

Task 7: Discussion (10 minutes)

- Put the learners in groups again to discuss the different jobs. They should discuss: 'What sort of person could be good for the different vacancies in the advert? What jobs from the advert do they think the three applicants should apply for? Why?' you may want to write these questions on the board.
- Encourage them to look at the problems each applicant had earlier in life and relate those to the job vacancies in the advert.

Cooler: Role-plays (15-20 minutes)

- Put the class into pairs and tell them to spend a few minutes choosing vocabulary to describe themselves, their work and free-time interests.
- Hand out **Resource 5** and explain that they will interview their partners and write their answers on the application forms. Tell the learners they can use some of the questions in Task 2 to interview their partners, but they will have to change them, to use 'you'. E.g. 'What's your name?' Elicit some other questions so that they can ask each other about their occupation, cell, prison number, etc. If necessary, put those questions on the board.
- When they are ready, they should do the role-play and complete the form for their partners. Afterwards, hand out another application form to each pair and ask students to swap roles.

Differentiation

Lower levels could do this as a speaking only exercise. Higher levels could ask more follow up questions.

Extension activities / Cell Homework

- Learners could write a short personal statement, describing their interests, what they enjoy doing and their personal qualities.
- They could find out about opportunities for support roles in their own prison.



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- They could choose a well-known person and describe him/her – likes, interests and personal qualities.



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Answer key

Resource 1 - Task 1 (Entry 3): 1. = c

2. = b

3. library orderlies; Listeners; peer mentors in education; recovery champions; editorial team for the prisoner magazine

4. Contact your PID worker on the wing or ask an officer

5. It can help you better yourself and do something worthwhile with your time.

You can even get a recognised qualification.

6. Depends on learners' opinions so accept any answers.

Resource 2 - Task 1 (Entry 1-2): 2. = jobs in prison

3. = library orderly; Listener; recovery champion; (education) peer mentor; magazine editor

4. = an officer

5. = you can get a qualification

6. = peer mentor

7. = library orderly

8. = Listener

9. = recovery champion

Resource 3 - Task 3

- What's his name?
- How old is he?
- What does he do/what's his job?
- What are his hobbies?
- What are his main strengths?

Resource 3 - Task 4

Name	Ben	Omar	Hosea
Age	44	29	35
Personal qualities	sure about what he wants, caring	creative	confident, enthusiastic
Free time	looking after animals	reading and writing	playing football
Strength	never gives up	always positive	ready to help others



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Warmer images



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Resource 1: Reading (Entry 3)

Read the text and discuss the questions and their answers with a partner.

HMP Nellton needs you!

Are you bored? Do you need something interesting to do to pass the time? Do you want to help other prisoners by sharing your experience, skills or knowledge? Then look no further!

We have lots of jobs here that can help you better yourself and do something good with your time. You can even get a qualification.

We have vacancies for the following:

- library orderlies – help in the library
- Listeners – help other prisoners by listening to their problems
- peer mentors in education – help with learning in a classroom
- recovery champions – help prisoners with drug or alcohol problems
- editors for the prisoner magazine – help design the magazine

1. What sort of text is this? Circle the correct answer.

a news story an email an advert

2. What is it about? Circle the correct answer.

getting qualifications job opportunities in prison being a Listener

3. What vacancies are there?

4. Who can you speak to for more information?

5. Why is it a good idea to do one of these prison jobs?

6. Which job do you think is interesting?



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Resource 1: Reading (Entry 1-2)

Read the text and answer the questions: tick ✓ the right answers.

HMP Nellton needs you!

Are you bored? Do you need something interesting to do to? Do you want to help other prisoners? Then look no further!

We have lots of jobs here that can help you better yourself and do something good with your time. You can even get a qualification.

job vacancies:

- library orderlies – help in the library
- Listeners – help other prisoners by listening to their problems
- peer mentors in education – help with learning in a classroom

1. What sort of text is this?

a letter ☐

an advert ☒

2. What is it about?

jobs in prison ☐

being a Listener ☐

3. What job vacancies are there?

library orderlies ☐

listeners ☐

kitchen staff ☐

recovery champions ☐

wing cleaners ☐

editors for the prisoner magazine



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4. Why is it a good idea to do one of these prison jobs?

You can get a qualification. ☐

You can read a lot of new books. ☐

6. Who works in a classroom?

7. Who works in the library?

8. Who listens to prisoners' problems?

9. Who can help a drugs user?

Resource 2: Vocabulary (personal qualities matching activity)

positive	you think about the good things in your life, not the bad things.
confident	you believe in yourself and you know the things you are good at.
helpful	you enjoy doing things to help others.
caring	you like looking after other people or animals.
enthusiastic	you are happy and excited about something. the crowd was enthusiastic when messi scored a goal in the football match.
creative	you like making things, or thinking of new ideas. examples of creative jobs are: artist, musician, writer, dancer, actor, inventor.

Resource 3: Meet the applicants

Here are three of the applicants from HMP Nellton. Make questions about them.

		
Hosea	Omar	Ben

- Name: What's his name?
- Age: _____?
- Occupation: _____?
- Interests? _____ interests?
- _____ strengths

Read about **one** man and write the answer to your questions in the table below.

Name	Ben	Omar	Hosea
Age		29	
Personal qualities			confident, enthusiastic
Free time			

Resource 4: texts for Resource 3: Meet the applicant

Ben Goodman

Animal lover Ben is very caring. He enjoys looking after animals and has two dogs at home. His biggest strength is that he never gives up and this helped him overcome a serious drink problem.

Age: 44 **First job:** working on a market stall, selling clothes.

Free time: Ben enjoys going to the gym and keeping fit. He's very sure about what he wants.

Ben admires John Bird, the man who started 'The Big Issue', a charity magazine, for his work with the homeless.

Favourite quote: "If you do not change your path, you could end up where you are going." (Lao Tzu)

Omar Siddique

Omar is very creative and also enjoys writing, but he always found school hard.

Age: 29 **First job:** helping in his parents' fish and chip shop when he was 14.

He learned to read two years ago and enjoys reading all kinds of books, especially autobiographies. He says that he always trusts his feelings and never feels bad about the past.

Omar's strength is that he is always positive.

Favourite quote: "He who opens a school door, closes a prison." (Victor Hugo)

Hosea John-Paul

Father of two, Hosea, likes playing football. Hosea says that he is confident and enthusiastic but that he is not afraid to show his emotions.

Age: 35 **First job:** climbing coconut trees and picking fresh coconuts for tourists

When he was younger, life was very hard and he once tried to kill himself. Luckily, someone helped him and now he's glad he had the chance to talk and someone was ready to listen to him.

Hosea's strength is that he's always ready to listen and help others.

Favourite quote: "If you're going through hell, keep going." (Winston Churchill)

Resource 5: Role-plays

Work with a partner.

Student A: You are recruiting for volunteers. Interview your partner and write down the information on the application form below.

Student B: You're talking to someone about one of the vacancies. You want to apply for one of the jobs. Answer your partner's questions- be as positive as you can about yourself! Use some of the vocabulary from today's lesson.

Role-play job application form

Application for _____ vacancy	
Name	Prisoner number
Cell	Current occupation
Personal qualities	
Free time interests	